

ENG 101

Lesson -29

Insert commas where needed in the following sentences.

- i. Before leaving home the child's nanny collected a milk bottle a bag full of diapers a blanket and a rattle.
- ii. Although he is eighty my grand dad walks ten miles daily.
- iii The cutlery box if I remember correctly is in the big trunk upstairs
- iv. The paint company displayed thirty shades of color but the fussy lady still could not find anything to order.
- V. The house agent said 'It may take you a while to get used to the place.'

Comma Rules.i. Between items in a series.

ii. After introductory material.

iii. Around words that interrupt the flow of sentence.iv.

Between complete thoughts connected by a joining word.

v. With direct quotations.

i. The village women sold pottery, baskets, blankets, and silver jewelry. (words)

ii. The women spread their wares on the pavements, on doorsteps, and especially under trees in the town square. (phrases)

(iii) The tribal elders took part in the dance, their women sold pottery and jewelry, and their children ran around happily playing games. (clauses).

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NOTE: Do not use a comma when the series contains only two items. e.g.

-The college cafeteria now serves sandwiches and cold drinks.

Practice 1.

In the following sentences insert commas between items in a series.

- i. Most countries now recycle newspapers plastic bottles and aluminum cans.
- ii. Walking jogging and bicycling are all inexpensive exercises.
- iii. The learner driver went through a red light steered off the side of a road and ended up on the footpath.

Rule No. 2 Comma After Introducing Material:

A comma is used to separate introductory material from the rest of the sentence. e.g.s

- *After the mother had given the baby a bath*, it feel asleep.
- *Pushing and shoving each other*, the ladies rushed into the sales section.
- *With the ceremony of releasing doves in the air*, the festival got off to a rousing start.

NOTE: The comma may be omitted if the introductory phrase / clause is so short that misreading is unlikely. e.g.
As the flames rose the crowd gave a shout.

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Practice 2.

Insert commas after the introductory phrase / clause in each of the following sentences.

i. When the lights went off the children let out a loud yell.ii. During the operation the doctor accidentally dropped the medicine bottle on the floor.iii. Disappointed by the batsman's performance the fans threw bottles and fruit peel at the fieldsmen.iv. After waiting in the queue for two hours the students were told that the office had run out of admission forms.

Rule No. 3. Put a comma around words that interrupt the flow of a sentence. Sometimes sentences contain material that interrupts the flow of thought. Such words or group of words should be set off from the rest of the sentence by commas e.g. *My mother, who is very old, complains that I do not give her enough time.*

One way of testing the interruption of the flow of thought is to read aloud such a sentence.

If you read aloud the above sentence you can hear the words *who is very old* interrupt the flow of thought. Such interruption often contain information that is *less* important to the sentence. e.g.s

-The owner of the house, *grumbling angrily*, came out of the house to claim his dog.-The college, *which was built in 1937*, needs a face lift.-The college auditorium, *though*, is in fairly good condition.

Practice 3.

Insert commas around the interrupting words in each of the following sentences.

- i. The house built of white stone was finally completed in 1890.
- ii. the park forty acres of prime land provides a fine view for the surrounding buildings.
- iii. The scenery of Switzerland which resembles that of Kashmir inspired him to write his novel.
- iv. Laila who was wearing a new dress yelled at the boys who spilled tea on her.

Rule No. 4. Comma between complete thoughts connected by a joining word.

When two complete thoughts are combined into one sentence by a joining word like and, but or so, a comma is used before the joining word. e.g.s

-Multan is one of the oldest cities in Pakistan,and its is also one of the most interesting.

- Some historians claim that Uch Sharif, another city in Punjab is older,but all agree that the Indus Valley has been continuously inhabited for thousands of years. -Perhaps you have read about this old city,or perhaps you have even visited Uch Sharif.-Money may not buy happiness,but it definitely makes misery bearable.

NOTE: Do not add a comma just because a sentence contains the word and, but or so. A comma is used only when the joining word comes between two complete thoughts. Each of those thoughts must have its own subject and verb. e.g.

i.-Shama spent the morning in the college, and then she went to the civil secretariat. (comma: each complete thought has a subject and a verb. Shama spent; and she went)

ii. - Shama spent the morning in the college and then went to the civil secretariat. (No comma: the second thought is not complete because it doesn't have its own subject.)

Practice 4: Insert commas before the joining words in the following sentences.

(i) The cricket team has lost five matches in a row but they are as popular as ever.(ii) Kauser wasn't wearing her reading glasses so she couldn't read the fine print in the dictionary.(iii) I used to be able to play the sitar very well but now I'm out of practice.(iv) It is not a festival precisely nor is it a village fair.

Rule 5. Comma with Direct Quotations e.g.s

-The coach shouted, 'Move, move fast'. - The student said, "Do you mind if I ask a question?"-The customer grumbled

to the waiter, "This tea tastes like ditch water.'

Note: e.g. - "After this class," whispered one student to her friend, "Let's go to the cafeteria."

Practice 5. Insert commas to set off quoted material in the following sentences..

(i) 'We are ready to leave' said a cheerful voice on the bus mike.

(ii) 'This book' complained the student to the book store owner "is twenty rupees cheaper at the other store."

(iii) The cashier said "we don't take cheques."

Review: See if you can recognize which comma rule applies to each sentence. Then identify the place where the comma(s) is / are required.

- a. Comma between items in a series.
- b. Comma after introductory material.
- c. Comma around interrupting words.
- d. Comma before a word that joins two complete thoughts.
- e. Comma with direct quotations.

1. Glaring around the room the boss demanded silence. (_____)

2. I heard a horn blowing so I glanced up at my rearview mirror. (_____)

3. The professor won't leave the house without his hat his briefcase and his umbrella. (_____)

4. The city children unused to the darkness of the forest sound it hard to sleep. (_____)

5. The man whispered "Listen very carefully to what I have to say". (_____)

The Apostrophe [,] Look at the following sentences and see if you can spot the word that needs the apostrophe.

1. It's impossible to see stars in daylight.

2. The judge can't hear the case until next month.

3. No one likes the college principals new attendance rules

4. The sandwiches at Greens restaurant are the best in town
I+am=I'm

She+will=she'll

it+is=it's

You+will=you'll

Does+not=doesn't

You+would=you'd

Do+not=don't

Will+not=won't

Wouldn't you like to go to the movies tonight? There's a film I've been wanting to see, but it hasn't been in Lahore until now. You've been wanting to see it too, haven't you? Shouldn't we ask the others to go with us? They're always saying they've plenty of free time, don't they?

1.They're their

2. It's its

3. You're your

4. Who's whose

-They're upset about the damage done to their new car.

- It's a shame that the college failed to honor its own faculty.

-Your parents said you're their favorite child.

- Who's the person whose car number plate is missing.

The Apostrophe to Show Possession [' s]

- This is a man's job

- These are men's jobs

- Children's games are not always simple

- My sister-in-law's great love is shopping.

-She reads Huxley's essays.

In the case of plural nouns ending in S, the apostrophe alone is used.

- She rang the Shahs' doorbell.

- The two dogs' tracks were visible in the snow.

- The ladies' toilet / wash-room was locked.

When Not to Use An Apostrophe: In Plurals and Verbs

i. Samina's new boots have golden buckles.

-Many verbs end with an S. e.g.

-ii. He owns the cinema.

*Ow*ns is a verb. Do not put an apostrophe in a verb.

Practice 6.

Add an apostrophe where necessary

(i)(i)The head of the departments mood is much better after he gives out the assignments for the day.

(ii) This years new television shows are much worse than the programs of last year.

(iii) Mind your ps and qs.

Review: Identify the correct answer.

1. A contraction is two words combined into

- a. one word
- b. a possessive
- c. a plural

2. In the contraction she'd, the apostrophe

- a. shows that *she* posses something
- b. takes the place of woul
- c. indicates a plural

3. To make a possessive, an apostrophe plus an s is usually added to

- a. the name of the owner
- b. whatever is owned

4. An apostrophe is not needed in

- a. a contraction
- b. a plural

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